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Digital Literacy & Professional Development Project Report

Task 1: Professional Presentation with Canva

For the first phase of this project, I utilized Canva, a versatile cloud-based design platform known for its intuitive interface and high-fidelity graphic capabilities. Unlike traditional, text-heavy slide software, my design for this presentation focuses on visual storytelling and professional branding. I leveraged Canva's extensive library of design elements to create a cohesive aesthetic, ensuring that each slide acted as a clear, impactful chapter in the narrative of digital citizenship.

The most interesting aspect of using Canva was mastering the balance of visual hierarchy. It requires a different mindset to curate a layout where the typography, icons, and white space all work together to guide the viewer's eye to the most important information. I found it fascinating how subtle design choices—like consistent color palettes and the strategic use of grids—could make complex topics like cybersecurity and online safety feel much more accessible.

The most difficult part was maintaining information density without cluttering the slides. Because Canva offers such a vast array of stickers, photos, and frames, I had to exercise creative

discipline to ensure the visuals enhanced the message rather than overshadowing the content. I focused on "less is more," making sure every element served a specific purpose in the presentation.

Task 2: Professional Platform Integration

To build a professional foundation, I established accounts on LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle.

- LinkedIn serves as my primary professional network for connecting with peers, professors, and industry leaders.
- GitHub is utilized as a version control platform and a repository for my coding projects, showcasing my technical proficiency to potential recruiters.
- Kaggle provides a dedicated space for data science and machine learning, o ering datasets and competitions to sharpen my analytical skills.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a living portfolio of my growth. On GitHub, I will document my progress from simple scripts to complex AIML models, ensuring every project is well-documented. On LinkedIn, I will share my certifications and campus involvements (like my work with the Quantum Intelligence Club) to build a credible brand. Finally, I will use Kaggle to transition from theoretical classroom learning to solving real-world data challenges, eventually participating in global rankings to demonstrate my expertise to the tech community.

Task 3: Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz

I utilized Google Forms to design a five-question 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' for my batchmates. The platform was chosen for its ease of use, real-time data visualization, and accessibility across mobile devices. By building this quiz, I practiced the skill of structured data collection—learning how to phrase questions clearly to avoid bias while ensuring the results are measurable. I specifically focused on questions regarding password hygiene, phishing recognition, and safe browsing habits.

Academically, mastering Google Forms is highly beneficial. It allows me to conduct surveys for research projects, gather feedback for club events, and organize large amounts of information e iciently. In the context of my AIML studies, understanding the "source" of data (the survey itself)

is a fundamental lesson in data integrity. Using these tools helps me bridge the gap between technical theory and practical application, ensuring that I can not only build models but also gather the quality data required to train them e ectively.

Task 4: Responsible Social Media Use

The Impact of Digital Communication

A notable real-world problem occurs when "private" venting in a group chat is leaked. For example, a student might make a disparaging comment about a professor or peer in a WhatsApp group, which is then screenshotted and shared publicly. This can lead to formal disciplinary action or ruined professional relationships before a career even begins. What could have been done dierently is practicing digital restraint. If a concern is legitimate, it should be addressed through o icial college channels or private, verbal conversations. Understanding that "private" digital spaces are rarely truly private is a lesson in maintaining professional integrity across all platforms.

Do's and Don'ts Checklist

Do's (Best Practices)	Don'ts (Avoid These)
Audit Privacy Settings regul	Don't share location data in real-time.
Network on LinkedIn with i peers.	Don't vent about faculty or college online.
Fact-check info before hittir	Don't engage with online trolls or bullies.
Highlight certifications and	Don't post sensitive docs like ID cards.

Use 2FA on all social accounts.	Don't ignore your "permanent" footprint.	

Task 5: Cybersecurity Awareness & Prevention Part A: Case Study – UPI "Collect Request" Fraud

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is a prevalent financial cybercrime in India that relies on social engineering rather than technical hacking. It typically occurs when a scammer poses as a customer care representative or a buyer on a marketplace.

The Step-by-Step Process:

1. The Bait: The fraudster contacts the victim, claiming there is a pending refund or a payment for a listed item.
2. The Request: Instead of sending money, the attacker sends a "Collect Request" via a UPI app (like PhonePe or Google Pay).
3. The Deception: The attacker tells the victim over the phone that they must "enter their PIN to receive the money."
4. The Theft: The moment the victim enters their PIN, they are actually authorizing a debit from their own account. The money is instantly transferred to the attacker.

Target & Consequences:

The primary targets are often college students and elderly individuals who are comfortable with technology but may not fully understand the underlying mechanics of UPI transactions. The consequences are immediate financial loss and a severe compromise of digital trust. Because UPI transfers are instantaneous, recovering the funds is extremely di icult once the transaction is authorized.

Part B: Stay Safe Online Checklist Reflection

The most surprising thing I discovered while researching the "Stay Safe Online" checklist was the psychological pressure scammers use. They don't just send a link; they create a sense of extreme urgency—claiming a bank account will be blocked or a "limited-time" refund will expire—to stop the victim from thinking clearly. I was also surprised to learn how often scammers use "mule accounts" to bounce stolen money through several layers within minutes, making it nearly untraceable.

As a result, the one habit I will personally change is enabling transaction limits on my UPI app. By setting a daily cap on how much can be transferred, I can mitigate the potential damage even if a security lapse occurs. Additionally, I have committed to never answering "Collect Requests" from unknown IDs.